

Chapter 98-5

Liang Shi: "....."

Her feelings were complicated.

But could this be credited to her brilliant acting just now?

Liang Shi didn't know. She only knew she seemed to have been fed dog food.¹

Then she also picked up a piece and held it to Xu Qingzhu's mouth.

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

"What are you doing?" Xu Qingzhu said. "I'm already full."

"Eat one more." Liang Shi said softly. "Teacher Xu should get the same treatment that others get."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

"You mean the treatment of watching Teacher Liang cheat on my good friend back then?" Xu Qingzhu leaned close to her ear and whispered. "Teacher Liang really is quite willing to sacrifice for Dr. Zhao."

Liang Shi: "....."

What had she done wrong to have to experience this kind of public humiliation scene so early in the morning?!

But Xu Qingzhu did take a bite. Half still remained on the chopsticks. Xu Qingzhu shook her head. "I really can't eat anymore."

Liang Shi looked at it, feeling it shouldn't be wasted, but... Xu Qingzhu had already bitten it.

"If you're a germaphobe, just throw that half away..." Before Xu Qingzhu could finish speaking, Liang Shi had already stuffed that half into her own mouth.

Xu Qingzhu pressed her lips together and said nothing.

As for Zhao Xuning and Shen Hui's side, the two were terrifyingly silent, yet they naturally gave off an aura that made others not dare to disturb them.

After Shen Hui finished eating that piece, Zhao Xuning still said softly, "You're too thin now."

Shen Hui glanced at her lightly. "You're not much better."

Zhao Xuning smiled bitterly. "Isn't that exactly what you wanted?"

Both of their voices were low. But Shen Hui seemed to have thought of something. After spacing out for a moment, her attitude toward Zhao Xuning wasn't as cold as before. Instead, there was an indescribable tenderness when she spoke, and the tense atmosphere between them vanished in an instant.

Shen Hui said coldly, "I never wished for my ex-girlfriend to die after we broke up."

"Even if you did, it wouldn't matter." Zhao Xuning said. "I brought it on myself."

"As long as you know." Shen Hui said.

The two chatted intermittently while Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu sat across from them watching.

Suddenly, Liang Shi couldn't help but speak up. "Why can't people who love each other be together? In this world, it's already so hard to find mutual love."

Zhao Xuning kicked her under the table, not wanting her to say anything more.

But Shen Hui glanced at her. "You look pretty smart."

Liang Shi: "....."

The implication being—didn't expect you to be this stupid.

"I just feel sorry for you two." As someone who had already died once, what Liang Shi felt most keenly was the unpredictability of life. So she wanted to encourage the two of them to love recklessly while they still loved each other. Otherwise, when one of them disappeared or died, that would truly be a lifelong regret.

"No one knows how long they'll live in this world, so why not do what you love?" Liang Shi said gently. "Love the person you love, do the things you want to do. If one day the person you love suddenly died, how regretful would that be?"

Although she was expressing her views, there wasn't a hint of preaching. It wouldn't make anyone uncomfortable.

For a moment, it actually made people follow her train of thought.

If someone you loved dearly suddenly disappeared from this world one day, you would probably be in pain and miss them for the rest of your life.

Nothing is more unforgettable than death.

Zhao Xuning suddenly looked at Shen Hui, but Shen Hui lowered her eyes, refusing to meet her gaze.

All four fell silent. It was Shen Hui who broke the silence first. "But some people never even got to see this world. I think that's the most regrettable thing."

"And I need to spend my whole life making up for that regret." Shen Hui added.

Her voice was cold, but there was a hint of heartache in it.

"A-Hui..." Zhao Xuning called out to her softly.

"Dr. Zhao." Shen Hui pulled herself out of her memories and said coldly, "We've already broken up. There's no need to call me so intimately. After all, you already have a lover."

Zhao Xuning tried to explain. "No..."

Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu were simultaneously surprised. How did they not know Zhao Xuning had gotten a new girlfriend?

But then Shen Hui looked at Xu Qingzhu. "Beautiful, find a new wife."

Xu Qingzhu: "Hm?"

"An Alpha who doesn't respect herself is like rotten cabbage." Shen Hui said. "You're so good. She doesn't deserve you."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

Xu Qingzhu couldn't help but laugh.

"Oh, right." Shen Hui felt her revenge wasn't enough and continued speaking to Xu Qingzhu. "Miss Liang said her one true love is Dr. Zhao. I think you should grant their wish. With your excellent qualities, what kind of Alpha couldn't you find? If it really comes down to it, I'll go through a second differentiation and you can be with me instead."²

Liang Shi: "?"

"Sis." Liang Shi was shocked by her words and couldn't help saying, "Are you really trying to steal someone's wife like this? I'm still right here."

Shen Hui swept a flat glance at her. "Who's your sis? Stop randomly claiming relatives."

"I'm the same age as Zhao Xuning." Liang Shi said. "And I'm calling you sis purely to express my apology... I shouldn't have done that earlier. I'm sorry for hurting your heart that still loves Dr. Zhao."

Shen Hui: "?"

"Where did you get the idea that I still love her?" Shen Hui scoffed lightly, confronting her head-on. "Don't meddle in other people's relationship issues, thank you."

Liang Shi: "....."

She was starting to regret everything she had done this morning.

Shen Hui then said to Xu Qingzhu, "If you don't divorce her, I'd feel sorry for you."

Liang Shi wished she could cover Xu Qingzhu's ears right now. But Xu Qingzhu calmly looked at Shen Hui and raised an eyebrow with a smile. "Tell me more."

Shen Hui clicked her tongue. "Miss Liang said this morning that she and Dr. Zhao are the true love, and that her marriage with you is just a sham marriage with no feelings. You're not divorcing after all that? That doesn't make sense."

Liang Shi: "....."

She guiltily lowered her head, helplessly pressing her forehead. Under the table, she kicked Zhao Xuning, signaling her to quickly make Shen Hui stop talking.

If this continued, she felt like she was going to be bitten to death by Xu Qingzhu.

But then Zhao Xuning said, "I don't love her. She's the one who threw herself at me. Xu Qingzhu, I also think you should consider getting a divorce."

Liang Shi: "?"

.....

Liang Shi knew her friendship with Zhao Xuning was plastic,³ but she didn't expect it to be this plastic.

It was like a plate of loose sand—it didn't even need the wind to blow before it scattered on its own.

Great.

Liang Shi stepped on Zhao Xuning's foot under the table. But Zhao Xuning said expressionlessly, "Liang Shi, your acting is really terrible. I don't think the entertainment industry is right for you. Go find a factory job."

Liang Shi: "....."

Shen Hui added from the side, "Whether she works or not doesn't matter. The key point is that I think the beautiful lady should get divorced."

Liang Shi looked at Xu Qingzhu, her gaze innocent and aggrieved, as if saying—see how they're all bullying me?

Xu Qingzhu stifled a laugh, patted her shoulder, and played along perfectly. "So the secret about Teacher Liang and my sham marriage is finally out?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Footnotes:

¹ "Fed dog food" (吃狗糧, chī gǒuliáng): Chinese internet slang for being subjected to public displays of affection from couples, making single people or bystanders feel like they're being forced to watch others' romantic interactions.

² "Second differentiation" (二次分化, èrcì fēnhuà): In ABO dynamics, this refers to a rare phenomenon where someone's secondary gender changes or develops further after their initial presentation. Here, Shen Hui is joking that she (presumably a Beta or Omega) could differentiate into an Alpha to be with Xu Qingzhu.

³ "Plastic friendship" (塑料友誼, sùliào yǒuyì): Chinese internet slang describing a fake or superficial friendship that appears close on the surface but is actually fragile and insincere—like plastic that looks nice but breaks easily.